

4.1 BitTorrent

4.1.1 Introduction

Bram Cohen created BitTorrent, the first BitTorrent client, using the Python programming language. It is considered rather basic. This drawback was rectified by buying μ Torrent—another BT client—and re-branding it. All versions of BitTorrent up to 5.2 are “original.” BitTorrent is open source and cross-platform. We shall discuss the last original version of BitTorrent (5.2).

At first glance, the spartan interface of BitTorrent makes it clear that simplicity of use is the focus here. There are comparatively fewer buttons and menu options.

4.1.2 Usage

A new torrent download can be started by clicking on the Add button and providing the path or URL to the torrent file. The location to save the datafile is asked next, after which the download begins.

Torrent File List Peer List Speed Comments Log						
Address	Client	% complete	KB/s...	KB/s up	Downloaded	
91.66.129.87	Azureus 3.0.4.2	100.0	1 KB/s	0 KB/s	32 KB	
bast-montreal-1096410...	μ Torrent 1.7.5.0	100.0	1 KB/s	0 KB/s	128 KB	
59F5E608.veranet.de	Azureus 2.5.0.0	100.0	1 KB/s	0 KB/s	32 KB	
chello084112052122.29.1...	Shareaza 2.3.0.0	100.0	0 KB/s	0 KB/s	16 KB	
static-business-212-101-2...	Azureus 3.0.4.2	100.0	0 KB/s	0 KB/s	16 KB	
adul-dyn-88-208-130-194...	BitLord 1.01	100.0	0 KB/s	0 KB/s	0 B	

Peer statistics (stats) in the original BitTorrent

To view the download speeds of the client, enable the View Details option under the View menu. This brings up a frame in the lower half of the client window, which shows the download speeds graphically. Other information like the total bytes transferred and the average speeds are also displayed. A torrent is accorded normal priority by default. To selectively increase or decrease the speed of a particular torrent, its priority can be increased or decreased under the Torrent menu or by accessing the torrent’s context menu.